

# Youhyun Sung

Seoul, South Korea | youhyun8808@gmail.com | youhyun-sung.github.io | github.com/youhyunsung

## Research Interests

---

### Visual perception, perceptual ambiguity, empirical aesthetics, neuroaesthetics, and illusion

*Research focus: how visual cognition, spatial ambiguity, and perceptual organization shape aesthetic experience*

## Education

---

### Seoul National University

*M.A. in Aesthetics*

– Graduate study in aesthetics, art theory, and visual perception.

2022 – 2026

Seoul, South Korea

### Hanyang University

*B.A. in German Language & Literature*

– Entered with honors and graduated with honors.

2015 – 2021

Seoul, South Korea

### University of Stuttgart

*Exchange Student*

– Completed exchange study supported by the Baden-Wurttemberg Stipendium.

2018 – 2019

Stuttgart, Germany

## Research Experience

---

### Cognitive Systems Lab, Korea University

*Research Assistant*

- Working under Prof. Christian Wallraven in Brain and Cognitive Engineering.
- Conducting research on Op Art, matched optical illusions, spatial ambiguity, and aesthetic preference.
- Developing behavioral experiments and eye-tracking pilot work on afterimages and self-directed visual exploration.
- Preparing manuscripts and conference work for *Art & Perception*, VSAC, ECVP, and related outlets.

Nov. 2025 – Present

Seoul, South Korea

## Publications & Manuscripts

---

### Sung, Y., Sung, M., Carbon, C., & Wallraven, C.

*Does Spatial Ambiguity Contribute to Aesthetic Preference? Evidence from Op Art and Matched Control Stimuli.*

– *Art & Perception*. Accepted abstract, to be published.

2026

### Sung, Y., Sung, M., Carbon, C., & Wallraven, C.

*More Ambiguous, Not More Preferred: Spatial Ambiguity and Aesthetic Preference in Op Art.*

In preparation

### Sung, Y.

*Op Art and Its Visual Effect: Focusing on the Neural Mechanisms of Aftereffects.*

– Master's thesis, Seoul National University. OSF: 10.17605/OSF.IO/M32EV.

2026

## Conference Presentations

---

### Visual Science of Art Conference (VSAC)

2026

*Does Spatial Ambiguity Contribute to Aesthetic Preference? Evidence from Op Art and Matched Control Stimuli.*

- Selected for oral presentation after original poster submission.

### 48th European Conference on Visual Perception (ECVP)

2026

*Art wins: Higher Valuation Responses to Op Art Compared to Matched Optical Illusions.*

## Research Projects

---

### Tracing the Invisible

*Eye-tracking pilot study on afterimages and visual perception*

- Records how participants follow fading afterimages with gaze, translating subjective visual experience into behavioral data.

### Seeing Ambiguity

*Op Art, spatial ambiguity, and aesthetic preference*

- Compares Op Art stimuli with visually matched control images across viewing and re-evaluation conditions.

### Art? Illusion?

*Op Art, optical illusions, and aesthetic valuation*

- Examines willingness-to-pay judgments for Op Art images and matched optical illusion images.

## Work Experience

---

### Alto

2022 – 2025

*Freelance Event & Exhibition Staff*

Seoul, South Korea

- Supported Samsung IFA Berlin 2025, K-Science UK at the Korean Cultural Centre UK, Hyundai Motorstudio Heritage Exhibition Launching Show, Nike Jordan, and Nike Global projects.

### Cheil Worldwide

2019 – 2026

*Freelance Event & Brand Experience Staff*

Seoul, South Korea

- Supported Samsung ILP New York 2025, Samsung ILP New York 2024, Samsung IFA Berlin 2023, and Samsung IFA Berlin 2019.

### Frieze Seoul

2023 – 2025

*Freelancer*

Seoul, South Korea

- Supported event operations in an international contemporary art fair environment.

### 10th World Congress of Constitutional Law

Feb. 2018 – Jun. 2018

*Part-time Operation & Planning Staff, Sungkyunkwan University*

Seoul, South Korea

- Assisted program operations and planning for an international academic conference.

## Teaching & Service

---

### Homo Aestheticus Seminar

2026

*Organizer, Korea University*

Seoul, South Korea

- Organized a seminar featuring visiting professor Claus-Christian Carbon.

### Seoul National University

2025

*Teaching Assistant, Art and Science*

Seoul, South Korea

- Supported course delivery and instruction across one academic year.

## Awards & Scholarships

---

### Seoul National University Mentoring Scholarship

2022 – 2023

*Recipient*

Seoul, South Korea

- Awarded mentoring scholarship during graduate study.

### Baden-Wurttemberg Stipendium

2018 – 2019

*Recipient*

Germany

- Scholarship support of approximately EUR 7,000 for exchange study at the University of Stuttgart.

### Academic Excellence Scholarship, Hanyang University

2016 – 2017

*Recipient*

Seoul, South Korea

- Received merit-based academic scholarship.

## Languages & Certificates

---

### Languages

*Korean (Native), English (Fluent, C1), German (Fluent, C1), French (Basic, A2–B1)*

### Selected Certificates

*Goethe Institute C1; OPIc English AL; TOEFL iBT 107*

## Research & Technical Skills

---

### Research

*Psychophysics, behavioral task design, stimulus design, visual control, data cleaning, and statistical analysis*

### Technical

*JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Python, pandas, EEG, eye-tracking (Tobii), GitHub, OSF, LaTeX/Overleaf*